

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Redundant LE Summary

Skool.com/qroo

In Spanish, it's common—and often necessary—to include the **indirect object pronoun** (like *le* or *les*) **even when the indirect object is explicitly named**. This is called a **redundant pronoun**, and while it may seem unnecessary to English speakers, it's a natural and expected part of Spanish grammar with many common verbs.

1. Basic Structure

Example:

- *Le envié una carta a María.*
= I sent **her** a letter **to María**.

Even though *a María* is clearly stated, the **le** remains. That's the redundancy students struggle with—but it's standard Spanish.

Compare:

- *Le envié una carta.* = I sent **her** a letter.
- *Le envié una carta a Juan.* = I sent **him** a letter **to Juan**.

You can drop the “a + person,” but not the **le**.

2. Why It Feels Redundant to English Speakers

English does not use pronouns this way. We would never say “I sent **him** the letter **to John**.” So learners instinctively want to remove *le* or *les* when the recipient is mentioned—but Spanish requires it with many verbs.

3. Common Verbs That Take a Redundant LE

These are high-frequency verbs where you'll almost always see a redundant indirect object pronoun—even when the recipient is mentioned:

1. **Dar** – to give

- *Le di el libro a Juan.* = I gave the book to Juan.
- *Le di el libro.* = I gave **him** the book.

2. **Decir** – to tell / say

- *Le dije la verdad a María.* = I told María the truth.
- *Le dije la verdad.* = I told **her** the truth.

3. **Contar** – to tell (a story or joke)

- *Le conté un cuento a mi hijo.* = I told a story to my son.
- *Le conté un cuento.* = I told **him** a story.

4. **Comprar** – to buy (for someone)

- *Le compré un coche a mi esposa.* = I bought my wife a car.
- *Le compré un coche.* = I bought **her** a car.

(Note: Depending on context, this could also mean "I bought a car from her." Context clears it up.)

5. **Traer** – to bring

- *Le traje flores a mi madre.* = I brought flowers to my mom.

6. **Enviar / Mandar** – to send

- *Le mandé una carta a Pedro.* = I sent a letter to Pedro.

7. **Pedir** – to ask for something

- *Le pedí un favor a Juanita.* = I asked Juanita for a favor.

8. **Robar** – to steal (from someone)

- *Le robaron el bolso a Marta.* = They stole Marta's purse.
(Literally: "To her, they stole the purse.")

9. **Quitar** – to take away (from someone)

- *Le quité el juguete al niño.* = I took the toy away from the child.

10. **Prestar** – to lend

- *Le presté la bicicleta a Luisa.* = I lent the bike to Luisa.

11. *Devolver* – to return (to someone)

- *¿Le devolviste el libro a tu profesor?* = Did you return the book to your professor?

In Mexico, you'll often hear “**regresé el libro a mi profesor**” with *regresar* used like *devolver*—also taking *le*.

4. Extra Notes

- “**Le**” or “**les**” does **not** change to reflect gender, only number:
 - *Le* = to him / her / usted
 - *Les* = to them / ustedes
 - You can’t replace the pronoun with “a + person” alone—**both are expected**.
 - This isn’t universal across every verb. Some verbs don’t require a redundant *le*, but the ones listed above do in **99% of real-world usage**.
-

5. Why It Matters

Knowing which verbs use a redundant *le* helps learners sound natural and avoid confusion. If you omit *le* when it’s expected, native speakers may find your sentence off. If you get comfortable adding it, even when the recipient is named, your Spanish will feel more fluent and correct.